

BAIS: International Relations

Society in a Global Age

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Today at a Glance

Overview and what to focus on

Topic: how globalization has reshaped social life, and the political backlash that has followed.

- **Three frameworks:** Heywood & Whitham (sociological), Rodrik (political-economic), Mishra (psychological).
- **In-class exercise:** a five-case diagnosis of Rodrik's trilemma. No survey today.
- **Focus on:** the three frameworks and the trilemma. These are the exam material.
- **Optional:** the East Asia segment after the break is illustrative, not on the exam.

Exam Notes

What to know about the final

- **Date:** Wednesday, 27 May 2026. Resit: 30 June 2026. Both delivered via **ANS**.
- **Format:** 20 multiple-choice (50%) + 6 short-answer questions (50%), three from each instructor. **You answer four short answers: two from each set.**
- **Wk 11 focus:** the three frameworks and Rodrik's trilemma. The East Asia segment is illustrative, not on the exam.
- **Study guide:** on Brightspace – format details, candidate topics, glossary of key terms.

Roadmap

Where we are going today

1. Where we came from – review of weeks 1, 4, and 10
2. What globalization did to social life (Heywood & Whitham, ch. 7)
3. Rodrik's trilemma – and a five-country diagnosis exercise
4. **Break**
5. Mishra and the globalization of rage
6. Variations in populism: Latin America, Western Europe, East Asia
7. Bringing it together – back to lecture 1

No survey today – the diagnosis exercise replaces it. Definitions are in the appendix; full references are in the supplementary reading guide on Brightspace.

Where We Came From

The Through-Line of the Course

Three earlier weeks, one question for today

- **Week 1** (Wolff): the post-1989 wager – liberal democracy had won, globalization would do the rest. Fukuyama, Huntington, Kagan.
- **Week 4** (Denney): IR as a Western project – whose histories and concepts get to count as theory? Acharya, Global IR, double-binding.
- **Week 10** (Denney): the nation came back, often *because* of those changes. Resurgent nationalism in 2026 is a 21st-century response, not a 19th-century holdover.

Today's question

Why did belonging fragment, and why did globalization produce populism?

Today's Three Authors at a Glance

Three layers of one diagnosis

Author	Layer	Core claim
Heywood & Whitham (ch. 7)	Sociological	Social life thinned: from face-to-face community to mobile, individualized, digitally mediated ties.
Rodrik (2018)	Political-economic	Deep globalization, the nation-state, and democracy cannot all be fully maintained at once.
Mishra (2016)	Psychological / emotional	Modernity promised dignity and did not deliver. The political affect is rage.

Three layers, stacked. Each one needs the others to make sense.

Society in a Global Age

From Thick to Thin Connectedness

Heywood & Whitham, ch. 7

Thick

- Face-to-face, durable, localized
- Village, parish, trade union
- Few exits; identity inherited

Thin

- Mobile, individualized, digitally mediated
- Networks, platforms, online communities
- Many exits; identity assembled

Modern social life has been thinning for a century. The last twenty-five years did it at speed, and unevenly.

Post-Industrial Society and the Precariat

The labor underpinning of thinning

- Industrial economies built stable jobs, unions, careers, and the social trust that goes with them. Post-industrial economies built service work, gig work, and short-term contracts.
- The **precariat** (Standing, 2011) names the new class: workers on insecure, low-wage, fixed-term labor without the protections their parents' generation had.
- In rich democracies they are a sizable fraction of the under-40 workforce. They vote – often differently from their parents.

Source: Heywood & Whitham (2023), ch. 7; Standing, *The Precariat* (2011).

Risk Society and Liquid Modernity

Two diagnoses of the same shift

Risk society (Beck, 1992)

- Politics increasingly organized around the distribution of *bads*: climate change, pandemics, financial crises.
- Less about the distribution of *goods*: jobs, housing, healthcare, benefits.
- Modern institutions produce the very risks they claim to manage.

Liquid modernity (Bauman, 2000)

- Old social forms – family, class, profession – once fixed; now fluid.
- Freedom and uncertainty come together. People are told they are free; many feel adrift.
- Anxiety, isolation, and meaninglessness fill the gap left by stable forms.

When the social ground stops being solid, politics changes shape.

The Network Society

Castells (1996); the architecture of thin connectedness

- Decentralized, horizontal, code-organized – in theory. Open to new voices, accelerating new movements.
- Asymmetric and exclusionary – in practice. Power flows through platforms, algorithms, and infrastructures most users do not see.
- The **information society** is not a neutral knowledge economy. It is a contest over what counts as true and who gets heard.

Implication for nationalism

The same networks that allowed cosmopolitan publics to form also allowed nationalist publics to form – often more efficiently, because grievance moves faster than nuance.

Cultural Globalization: McWorld and Glocalization

Homogenization is half the story

- **Homogenization:** global brands, Hollywood, English-language media, a flattened aesthetic. Barber (1995) called this “McWorld.”
- **Glocalization** (Robertson, 1995): global products take local turns – kimchi burgers in Seoul, Bollywood adaptations of Hollywood plots, regional Netflix originals. Cultures hybridize.
- Both happen at once. The political question is whose voices set the terms of hybridization, and whose get erased.

What This Buys Us Analytically

The conditions, not yet the politics

- Heywood and Whitham give us the *conditions* under which a politics of resentment becomes possible: thinned ties, insecure work, fluid identity, mediated publics.
- They do not yet tell us why those conditions produce *this* politics: nationalism, populism, cultural-identity backlash.
- Rodrik adds the constraint that converts the conditions into politics. Mishra adds the affect that drives the politics into rage.

What the Thinning Looks Like

Two snapshots of social thinning in the US and UK

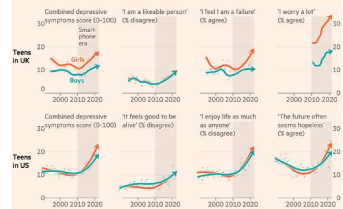
The share of US teens who only meet up with friends once a month or less has rocketed in the last decade, tracking worsening mental health

% of US teens who: a) only meet up with friends once a month or less, vs b) % who disagree with the statement that 'It feels good to be alive'



Sources: FT analysis of Monitoring the Future survey, based on prior work by Jean Twenge
FT graphic by John Burn-Murdoch / @burnmurdoch
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Depression, anxiety and other mental health problems are soaring among teenagers in the UK and US, especially among girls



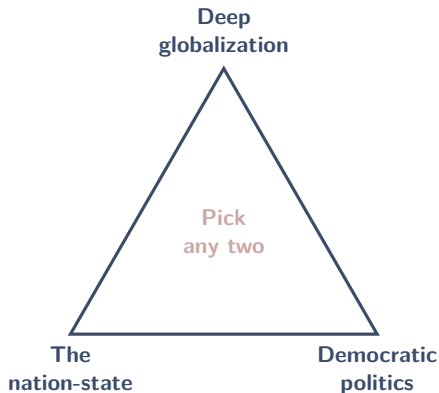
Sources: FT analysis of Understanding Society (UK) and Monitoring the Future survey (US), based on prior work by Jean Twenge
FT graphic by John Burn-Murdoch / @burnmurdoch
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Source: Financial Times, John Burn-Murdoch, based on Jean Twenge's analysis of the *Monitoring the Future* and *Understanding Society* surveys.

Rodrik's Trilemma

The Globalization Trilemma

Rodrik (2011, 2018) – pick any two



“We cannot simultaneously pursue democracy, national self-determination, and economic globalization.”

– Rodrik (2011), p. 200.

Rodrik’s claim is not that one corner is bad. It is that all three at full strength is structurally impossible. Some country, somewhere, is paying the price for any combination of the other two.

What Each Corner Costs You

The three two-corner combinations

Two you keep	What gets sacrificed	Empirical signature
Globalization + democracy	National policy autonomy	The EU project; international rules and technocratic delegation.
Globalization + nation-state	Democracy	The “golden straitjacket”: open economy + technocratic governance with thin democratic content.
Nation-state + democracy	Depth of globalization	Tariffs, capital controls, withdrawal from supranational rules.

“Depth” here is Rodrik’s word: regulatory harmonization across jurisdictions, not aggregate trade volume. A country can trade a lot *and* stay on the nation-state-plus-democracy corner.

Why Trade Generates Losers

Stolper–Samuelson in plain English

- Trade liberalization makes some factors of production worse off in absolute terms, not only in relative terms. Standard textbook result.
- As tariffs come down, the redistribution per dollar of efficiency gain *rises*. Late-stage globalization is more about distribution and less about expanding the pie (Rodrik, 2018, p. 18).
- Concrete signatures: the China trade shock cost roughly one in twenty US manufacturing jobs in exposed regions (Autor, Dorn & Hanson). NAFTA produced sharp wage penalties in industries the US had previously protected (Hakobyan & McLaren).

Why Compensation Rarely Comes

Two failure modes

- **Distortionary cost.** Redistributing the gains is expensive: it requires taxation, transfers, and active labor-market policy that themselves cost efficiency.
- **Time inconsistency.** Winners promise compensation *before* liberalization, when losers' votes are needed; they renege *after*, when the political moment has passed.
- Continental European welfare states are the partial exception that proves the rule: where compensation arrived, populist backlash arrived later and weaker.

Source: Rodrik (2018), pp. 18–20.

Country Diagnosis Exercise

In place of the survey – five cases, vote then reveal

The exercise

I will show you five countries. For each, the question is the same: **which corner of the trilemma has this country sacrificed – globalization, sovereignty, or democracy?** I will call out the three options in turn. **Raise your hand once**, when I name the corner you think was sacrificed.

- Five rounds. Vote first, then I reveal the canonical reading.
- These are not trick questions, but two of the cases will split the room.
- This maps directly onto Rodrik's framework. After the cases, the rest of the lecture is about why countries on the same corner produce very different politics.

Case 1: Greece in the Eurozone (2010s)

Vote: which corner is being sacrificed?

- Member of the Eurozone since 2001. No national currency, no independent monetary policy.
- Sovereign-debt crisis from 2009; austerity programs imposed under troika oversight (European Commission, ECB, IMF) from 2010 onward.
- July 2015 referendum: voters reject the bailout terms by 61%. The government accepts a harsher version of the same terms three days later.

Hands up when I call the corner Greece sacrificed:

G . S . D

Case 1 Reveal: Greece

Globalization + sovereignty (formally) – democracy squeezed

The reading

Greece kept economic openness and *formal* sovereignty, but the substantive content of democratic politics over fiscal and monetary policy moved to Brussels, Frankfurt, and Washington. The 2015 referendum is the canonical illustration: voters said no, the policy did not move.

- This is the corner the EU project lives on, in stronger or weaker form, for any member with a binding fiscal constraint.
- It is also why “technocracy” became a populist swearword in Southern Europe in the 2010s.
- The split in the room is usually between people reading the formal sovereignty as the live thing, and people reading the substantive democracy as the live thing.

Case 2: Brexit UK (2016–present)

Vote: which corner is being sacrificed?

- Referendum result, 2016: 51.9% Leave. Slogan: *take back control*.
- UK leaves the single market and customs union in 2020. New trade frictions; some new bilateral trade deals.
- Domestic political debate ever since runs on what the country gained (regulatory autonomy, immigration control) versus what it lost (EU market depth).

Hands up when I call the corner the UK sacrificed:

G . S . D

Case 2 Reveal: Brexit UK

Sovereignty + democracy – depth of globalization sacrificed

The reading

Brexit is the textbook nation-state-plus-democracy corner. “Take back control” is the slogan version of giving up depth – regulatory harmonization, free movement – in exchange for restored national policy autonomy and electoral primacy.

- Note: Brexiteers often claimed they would pursue *more* free trade outside the EU. On Rodrik’s framing, that is consistent with their corner – depth of integration is the sacrifice, not aggregate trade volume.
- This is the corner that the United States under Trump occupies in a sustained, electorally renewed form. The mechanism is the same; the politics around it differs in important ways we come back to.

Case 3: China (post-2001)

Vote: which corner is being sacrificed?

- WTO accession, 2001. Two decades of deep integration into global production networks; world's largest exporter of manufactured goods by 2009.
- Strong central state, retained policy autonomy on capital controls, industrial policy, technology, and subsidies.
- One-party rule throughout. Competitive multi-party elections never offered.

Hands up when I call the corner China sacrificed:

G . S . D

Case 3 Reveal: China

Globalization + nation-state – democracy never on offer

The reading

China is the cleanest case of the globalization-plus-nation-state corner. Deep integration with global markets combines with strong state policy autonomy; what gets sacrificed – electoral democracy – was never on the table.

- Rodrik's point: this combination is *coherent*, not paradoxical. The trilemma is a constraint, not a moral judgment.
- China is a competitor model to the EU's globalization-plus-democracy corner: same depth, different sacrifice.
- Liberal democracies facing China's competition feel pulled toward the same corner – giving up democratic accountability over trade and industrial policy.

Case 4: United States under Trump

Vote: which corner is being sacrificed?

- Tariffs reintroduced and escalated since 2017; renegotiation of NAFTA into USMCA; withdrawal from the TPP, Paris Agreement, WHO, UNESCO at various points.
- Sustained electoral mandate: two presidential election victories (2016, 2024) on an explicit America-First, anti-globalist platform.
- Increased restrictions on immigration; enhanced border enforcement; rhetorical and policy emphasis on national sovereignty.

Hands up when I call the corner the US sacrificed:

G . S . D

Case 4 Reveal: United States under Trump

Sovereignty + democracy – depth of globalization rolled back

The reading

Trumpism is the sustained, electorally renewed version of the Brexit corner. Tariffs, withdrawal from multilaterals, immigration restriction, and “America First” rhetoric all run on the nation-state-plus-democracy logic.

- Compare to Brexit: same corner, different politics. Brexit was a one-shot referendum; Trumpism is a sustained governing project that returns to the ballot.
- Compare to China: the US is moving *toward* China's depth-of-integration corner while preserving the electoral-democratic axis China does not have.
- This is what makes the second Trump administration analytically distinct from European right-populism – it sits inside the world's largest economy.

Case 5: Argentina (Milei era)

Vote: which corner is being sacrificed?

- History: cycles of economic populism (Perón, Kirchner), debt crises, IMF programs, and currency collapses. The country has spent the past 70 years moving between trilemma corners.
- Milei elected 2023 on a platform of dollarization, deregulation, and market liberalization. Aggressive shock therapy through 2024–26.
- Strong electoral mandate, contested democratic institutions, ongoing economic instability.

Hands up when I call the corner Argentina is sacrificing now:

G · S · D

Case 5 Reveal: Argentina

The country that cycles between corners

The reading

Argentina does not sit cleanly in one corner. Under Milei it is *aspiring* to globalization-plus-nation-state by giving up monetary sovereignty (dollarization). Under recent Peronist governments it leaned toward nation-state-plus-democracy with capital controls and protectionism. The trilemma operates here as a treadmill, not a fate.

- Argentina is the case that shows the trilemma as a *constraint*, not a destination. Same country, different governments, different corners.
- It also previews tomorrow's question: when economic shocks hit, the political response can be left-populist (Kirchner) or right-populist (Milei). Same trilemma, opposite politics. Why?

Break

See you in 10 minutes.

The Globalization of Rage

Mishra: Beyond Material Loss

Globalization as psychic dislocation

- Rodrik gives us the constraint, not the affect.
- Mishra (2016, 2017): globalization has produced uprooting – the loss of inherited frames that gave life shape.
- People told they are free; many feel abandoned. Abandonment breeds resentment.
- The result is rage: modern, dislocated, looking for political form.

“Self-seeking individuals with very different pasts now find themselves herded together into a global marketplace... where humiliating new hierarchies emerge.”

– Mishra (2016).

The Long Arc: 19th-Century Echoes

This has happened before

- Today's reactionary movements have ancestors: 19th-century romantic nationalists, anarchists, revolutionaries.
- Same grievances, different content. Then the railroad and the factory; now the algorithm and the migration flow.
- The lineage matters: this is not a temporary political pathology.

Three Layers Together

Where Mishra leaves us

- **Heywood and Whitham:** social life thinned. The conditions of belonging weakened.
- **Rodrik:** deep integration produced losers without compensation. The economic constraint hardened.
- **Mishra:** under both conditions, people feel cut adrift. The result is anger, organized around identity and belonging.

Where this leaves us

Populism is not a deviation from the post-1989 order. It is one of the political forms that order produces under predictable conditions.

Variations in Populism

Two Variants – Latin America and Europe

Rodrik (2018)

	Left-wing populism	Right-wing populism
Salient cleavage	Class – the people vs. the rich	Identity – the people vs. outsiders
Targets	Multinationals, neoliberalism, IMF, financial elites	Immigrants, supranational institutions, cosmopolitan elites
Geographic core	Latin America, parts of Southern Europe	Western and Eastern Europe, North America
Examples	Chávez, Morales, Kirchner, Correa	Le Pen, Orbán, Trump, Brexit, Wilders, Meloni

The two variants answer different questions, organized along different cleavages.

Patterns of Populism: Europe vs. Latin America

Rodrik (2018), Figure 4

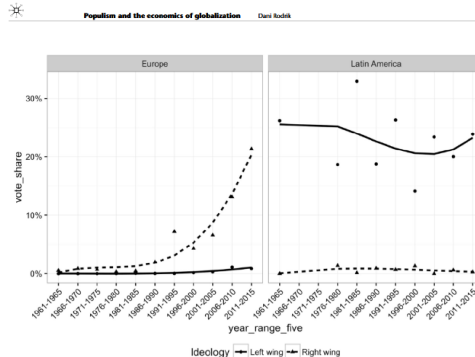


Figure 4 Contrasting patterns of populism in Europe and Latin America. Notes: See Appendix for sources and methods.

Vote-share of populist parties, five-year intervals. Europe: rising right-wing share; Latin America: persistent left-wing share.

Why the Variation? Rodrik's Answer

Demand vs. supply

- **Demand:** globalization shocks generate anti-establishment grievance.
- **Supply:** which cleavage gets activated depends on the type of shock.
 - Trade and finance shocks → class cleavage → left populism (Latin America).
 - Immigration shocks → ethno-cultural cleavage → right populism (Western Europe).
- The US in the 2010s had both shocks at once – Sanders and Trump on different cleavages of the same crisis.

An Important Pedagogical Caveat

Globalization $\neq$ Trump

The lazy reading

“Globalization explains right-wing populism.”

- Rodrik's framework explicitly resists this reduction. Globalization explains the *demand* for populism. It does not explain which form populism takes.
- The form depends on supply: the cleavages politicians can activate, the narratives in cultural circulation, the institutional channels available for grievance.
- Why does this matter? Two countries hit by the same globalization shock can produce opposite political responses. The variable doing the work is the political system that receives the shock, not globalization itself.

Optional Extension: East Asia

Time permitting – not on the exam

The next three slides extend the variation argument to Japan, South Korea, and Taiwan.

- Three mature democracies that face globalization shocks but do not produce durable populist parties.
- A useful test of the framework once we leave the Western cases.
- Cover if there is time; skip if not. Illustrative, not examinable.

East Asia – A Test of the Distinction

Three mature democracies, strong nationalism, no populist parties

- Japan, South Korea, and Taiwan have all been hit by globalization shocks comparable to those in Western Europe. None has produced a durable populist party.
- All three have strong nationalisms, but the nationalisms differ sharply – ethnic in Korea, civic in Taiwan, ancestry-based and institutionally absorbed in Japan.
- If populism is largely absent, and nationalism still varies, the two cannot be the same thing. Populism is a *repertoire*; nationalism is a *structure*.

Source: Klein, Schäfer & Zumbrägel (2025); see also speaker materials from the LUNN talk on Brightspace.

East Asia: Three Cases at a Glance

	Populist leaders	Mass attitudes	Populist party?
Japan	Episodic, subnational (Koizumi, Hashimoto, Koike)	Anti-elitism without anti-pluralism; LDP organization countermobilizes	None. Populism diffused into the mainstream party system.
South Korea	Diffuse across both major parties (PPP, DPK)	Sectarian: moral polarization at opponents, not at elites as a class	None. "Sectarian populism" filters through the existing party system.
Taiwan	Han Kuo-yu (KMT), 2018–20	Moderate; economic anxiety + cross-strait identity	None. Populist moments operate inside the KMT, not against it.

No country has a populist party. Populist rhetoric exists in all three; it does not consolidate into durable party organizations.

Why Japan Absorbs, Korea Diffuses, Taiwan Channels

Three different reasons for the same outcome

- **Japan.** LDP factions and intermediary groups absorb populist grievance inside the party system. Subnational breakthroughs only (Osaka, Tokyo).
- **South Korea.** Both major parties have adopted populist rhetoric; the variant is sectarian (aimed at the other party). The ethno-national imaginary preempts a clean people-vs.-elite cleavage.
- **Taiwan.** Cross-strait identity organizes party competition. Populist appeals run through the KMT and lose nationally when policy competence becomes the question.

The Take-Home from East Asia

Populism is a repertoire; nationalism is a structure

The lesson

Populism is a political repertoire that can be picked up and put down. Nationalism is the structural condition within which the repertoire either takes or does not.

- Same global shocks can produce far-right populist parties in Western Europe, sectarian populism inside mainstream parties in South Korea, and subnational populism in Japan. The variable doing the work is the political system that receives the shock.
- This pulls forward what we did last week. Korean ethnic nationalism and Ukrainian civic nationalism produced very different responses to crisis. East Asia is the same story, told one level up at the regional scale.

Bringing It Together

Three Layers, One Picture

Where the lecture leaves us

- **Sociologically:** stable forms of belonging thinned. Work became precarious; community became mediated; identity became a project.
- **Politically and economically:** deep integration constrained the policy space. Losers were not compensated. The trilemma became a live constraint, not a textbook abstraction.
- **Emotionally:** dislocation produces resentment, and the resentment looks for political channels.

Populism is the political form that the three layers, taken together, regularly produce – in the variant supplied by the cleavages each polity has available.

Returning to Lecture 1

Fukuyama, Huntington, Kagan – revised

	What was predicted	What this week's reading adds
Fukuyama (1992)	The end of ideological history – liberal democracy as the universal endpoint.	The ideological struggle may be over. The emotional struggle has just begun.
Huntington (1996)	A clash of civilizations – conflict on the cultural fault lines between major civilizations.	Today's turmoil is more often <i>inside</i> civilizations than between them. Identity is not destiny; it is a response to loss.
Kagan (2008)	The return of geopolitics – great-power rivalry back at the center of world politics.	True. But geopolitics now plus social fragmentation, plus precarity, plus rage. The great-power game runs on top of domestic populist pressure.

What Globalization Did, What It Did Not Do

Closing the balance sheet

What it did

- Lifted hundreds of millions out of absolute poverty
- Built dense multilateral institutions
- Intensified flows of goods, capital, information, people
- Made some countries – and some classes inside them – richer than ever

What it did not do

- Solve distribution within rich countries
- Compensate the regions and workers it disrupted
- Generate the social trust to absorb its losers
- Deliver the ideological closure Fukuyama imagined

The political question for the rest of the decade is which of these halves the next round of policy actually addresses.

*“We are more connected than ever –
but are we more together?”*

Next week: Mitchell on whether IR is going extinct.

The trilemma meets the planet.

Appendix: Definitions

Appendix: Definitions

Working terms from the lecture

Term	Working definition
Thin connectedness	Mobile, individualized, digitally mediated social ties; the opposite of face-to-face, durable, localized communities.
Precariat (Standing)	Workers dependent on insecure, low-wage, fixed-term labor without the protections that organized industrial workers had.
Risk society (Beck)	A society whose politics is organized around the distribution of <i>bad</i> s (climate, pandemics, crises) more than <i>good</i> s.
Liquid modernity (Bauman)	A condition in which family, class, and profession have lost their solidity – freedom and uncertainty arrive together.
Network society (Castells)	Society organized through decentralized, code-mediated networks; horizontal in form, asymmetric in practice.
Glocalization (Robertson)	The simultaneous globalization and localization of cultural products; hybridization rather than pure homogenization.

Appendix: Definitions (cont.)

Term	Working definition
Globalization trilemma (Rodrik)	Deep globalization, the nation-state, and democratic politics cannot all be fully maintained at once – pick any two.
Deep globalization	Regulatory harmonization across jurisdictions, not aggregate trade volume; this is what binds policy autonomy.
Stolper–Samuelson (intuition)	Trade liberalization makes some factors absolutely worse off; late-stage liberalization is more about distribution than expansion.
Compensation problem	Even when trade gains are large in aggregate, redistribution to losers fails: it is distortionary, and winners renege.
Globalization of rage (Mishra)	Globalization has produced not only inequality but psychic dislocation, expressed as resentment of modernity's broken promises.
Populism as repertoire	A political style of opposition (people vs. elite) that can be picked up by parties of left or right; distinct from nationalism.

Appendix: References

Cited on slides; full bibliography in the reading guide

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